

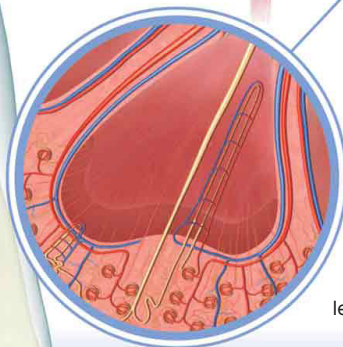
Inside a kidney

A kidney contains about a million urine-making units called nephrons. Blood from the renal artery passes into the nephrons, where urine is collected. The urine empties out into a ureter and the clean blood flows back into the rest of the body.

Renal artery

Renal vein

Ureter



To make urine, each **nephron** filters fluids from the body. As this fluid passes along the nephron's long, thin tubule (shown in yellow), nutrients and most water are absorbed into the blood. The water and waste left behind form urine.